

The Chalk-Trick



International Physicist Tournament Problem 11



« It is possible to draw continuous lines in a blackboard with chalk.

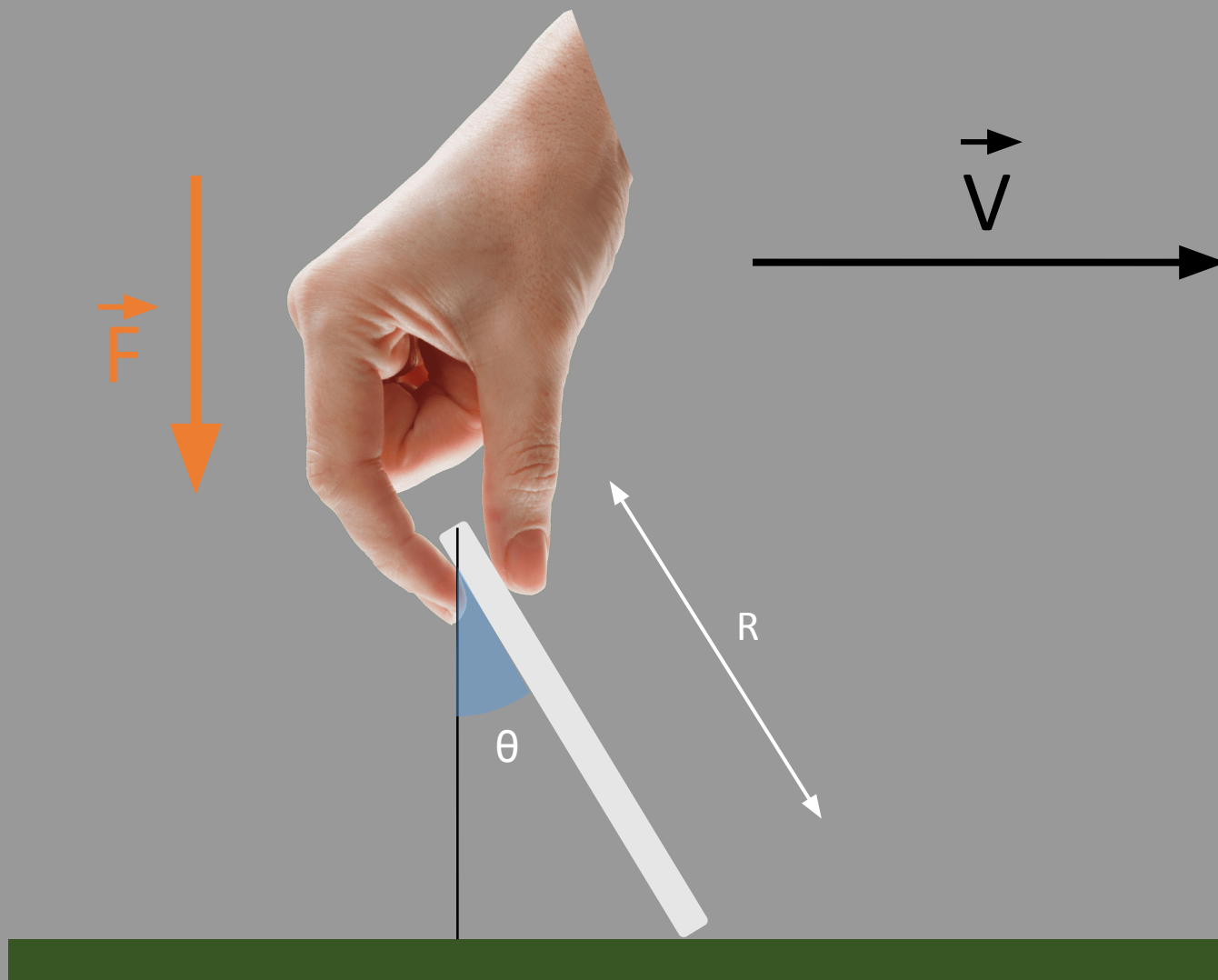
However, by changing the angle of contact, the line drawn on the board becomes a dotted line, though the movement is still continuous.

What parameters from the relative movement between the chalk and the board can be inferred from the resulting trace? Is it possible to infer anything about the dimensions of the chalk? »





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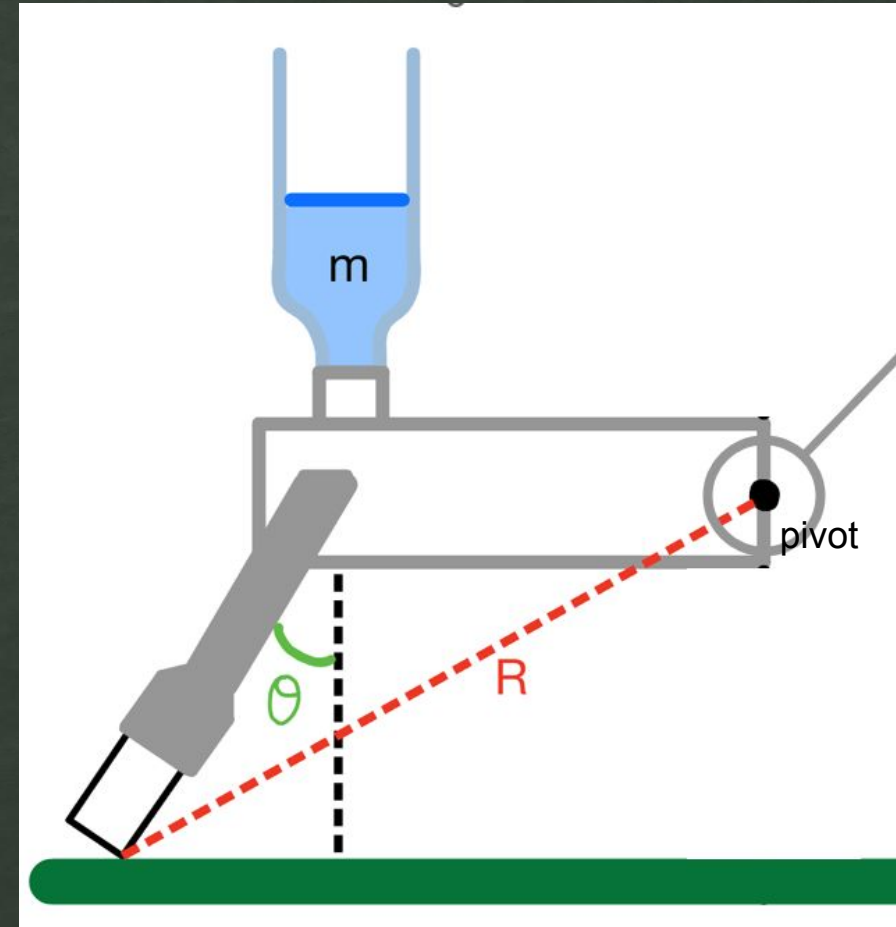
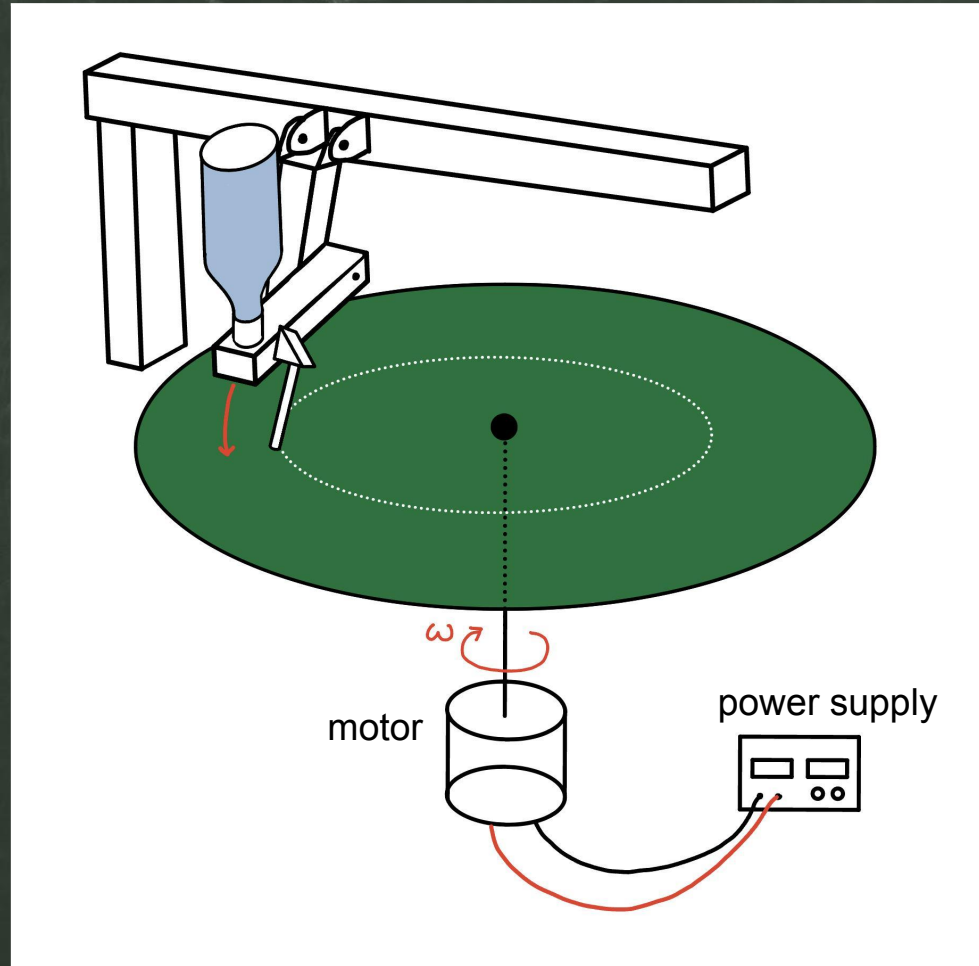


4 parameters :

- Length of the chalk (cm)
- Velocity V (m.s⁻¹)
- Force F (N)
- Angle θ (degrees)

II. Experiment

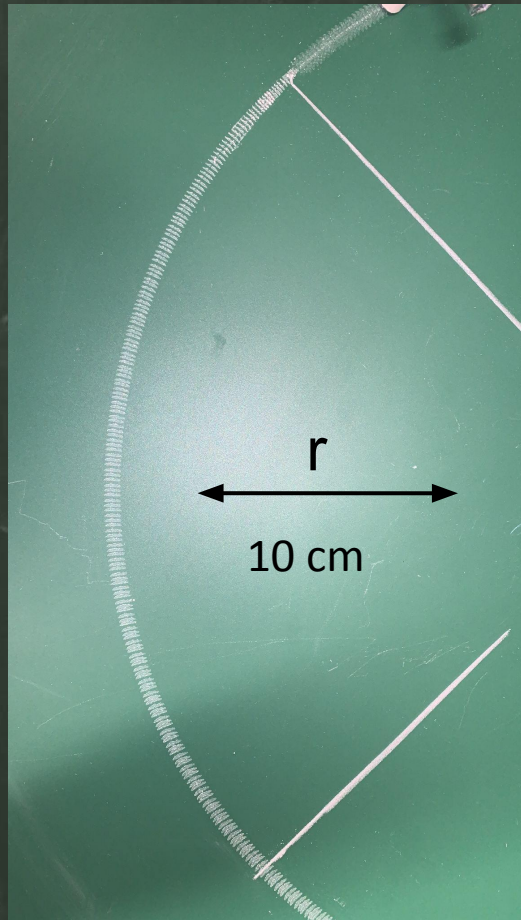
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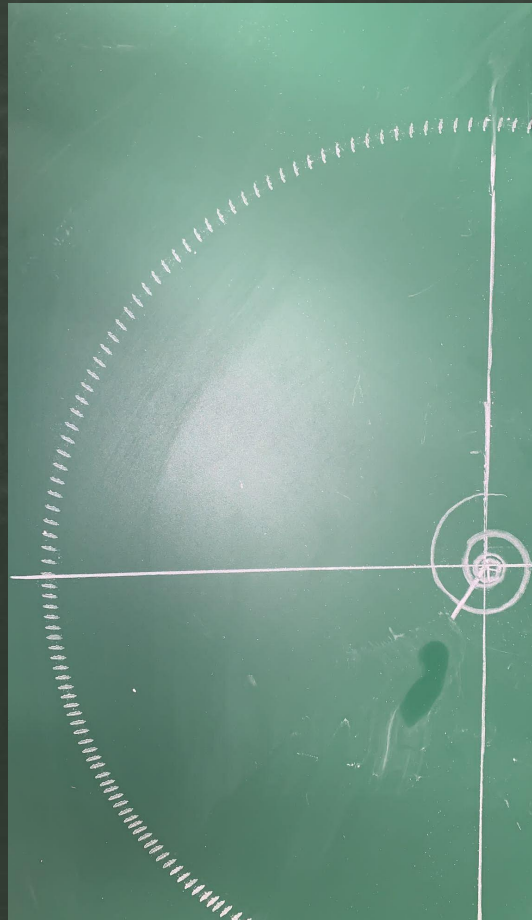
III. Results

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III.A – Movement velocity



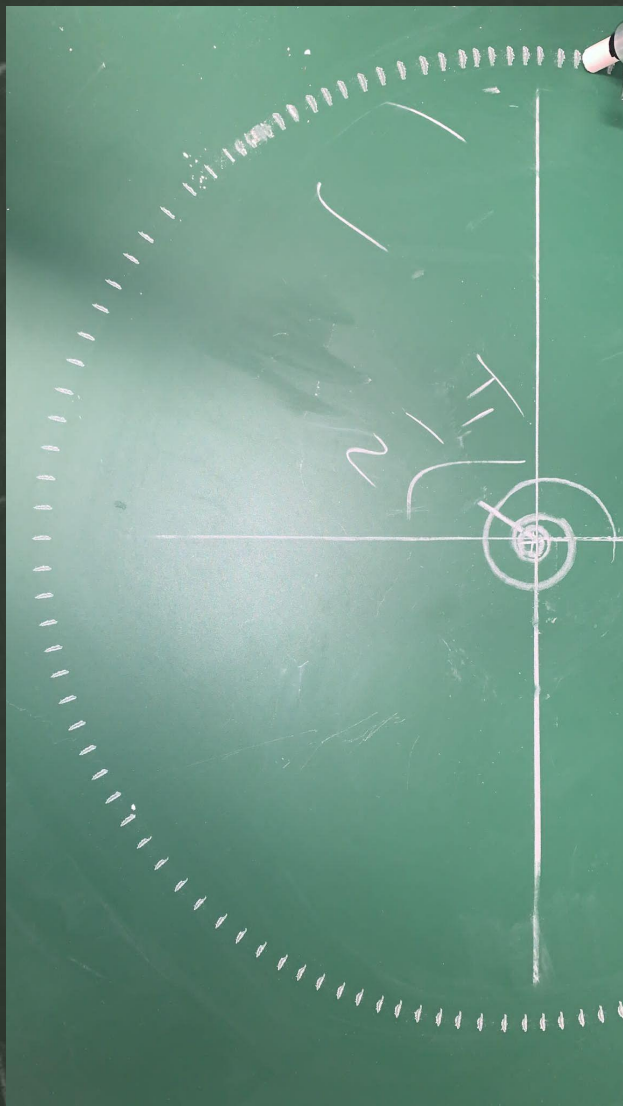
0.92 rad/s



1.84 rad/s



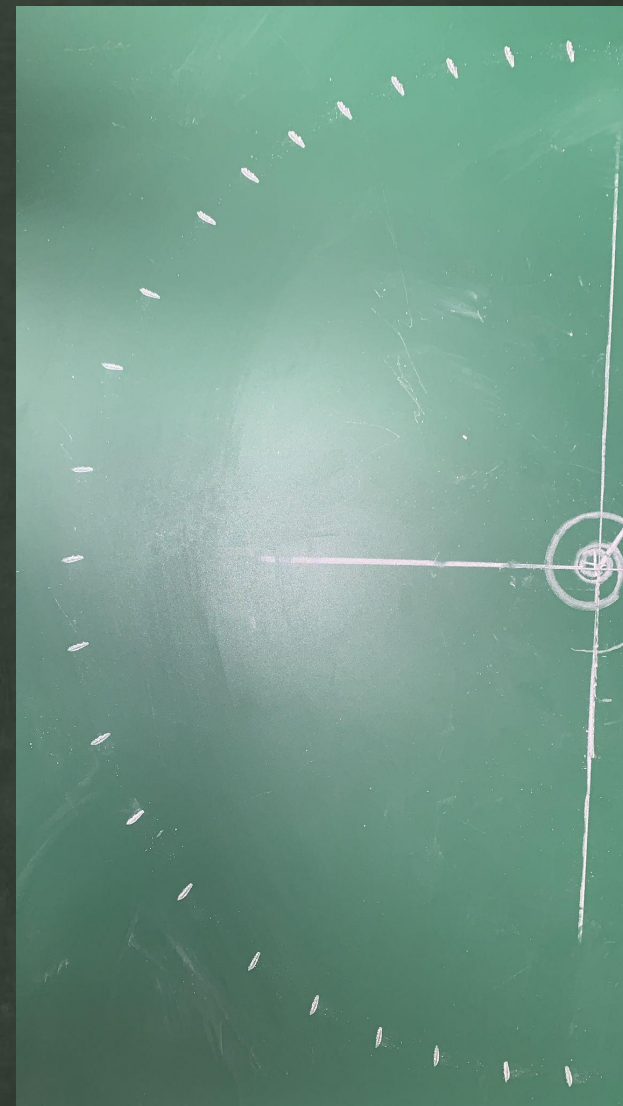
2.76 rad/s



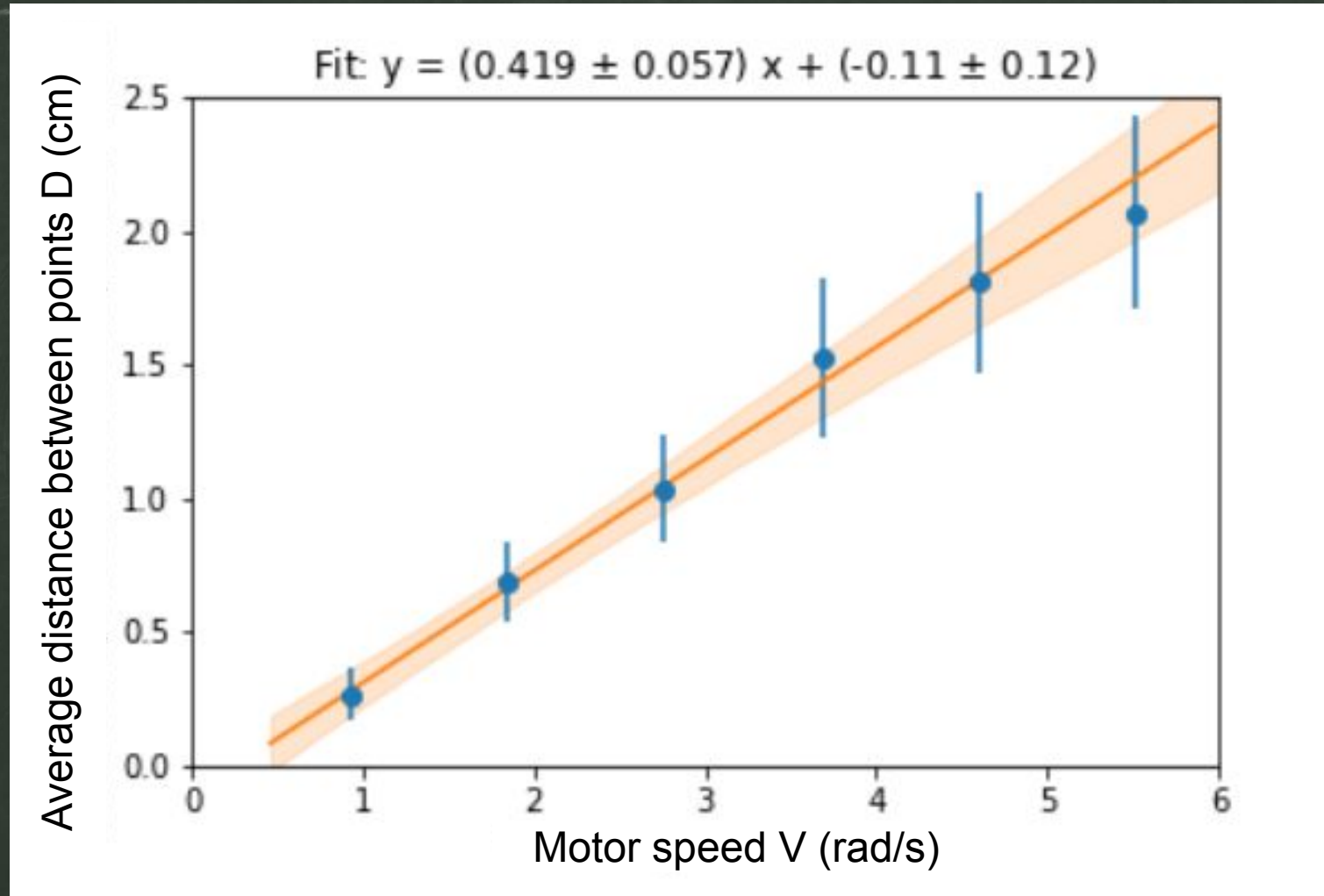
3.68 rad/s



4.60 rad/s



5.52 rad/s



$$D = V \times T$$

$$V = r \times \omega$$

The distance between points is proportional to the speed

Switching to acoustic measurements with metal “chalk”

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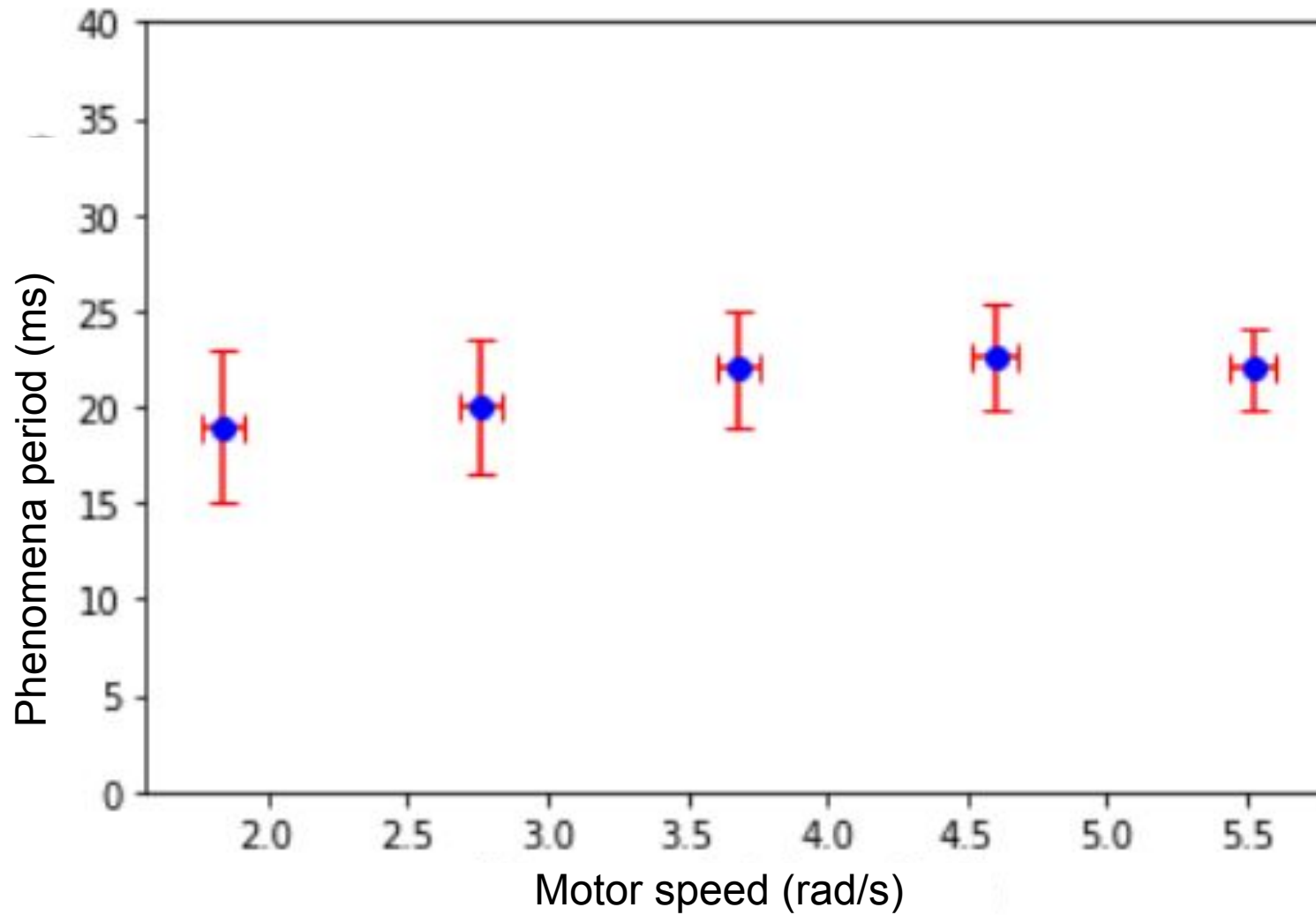


Chalk attrition!



III.A – Motor speed

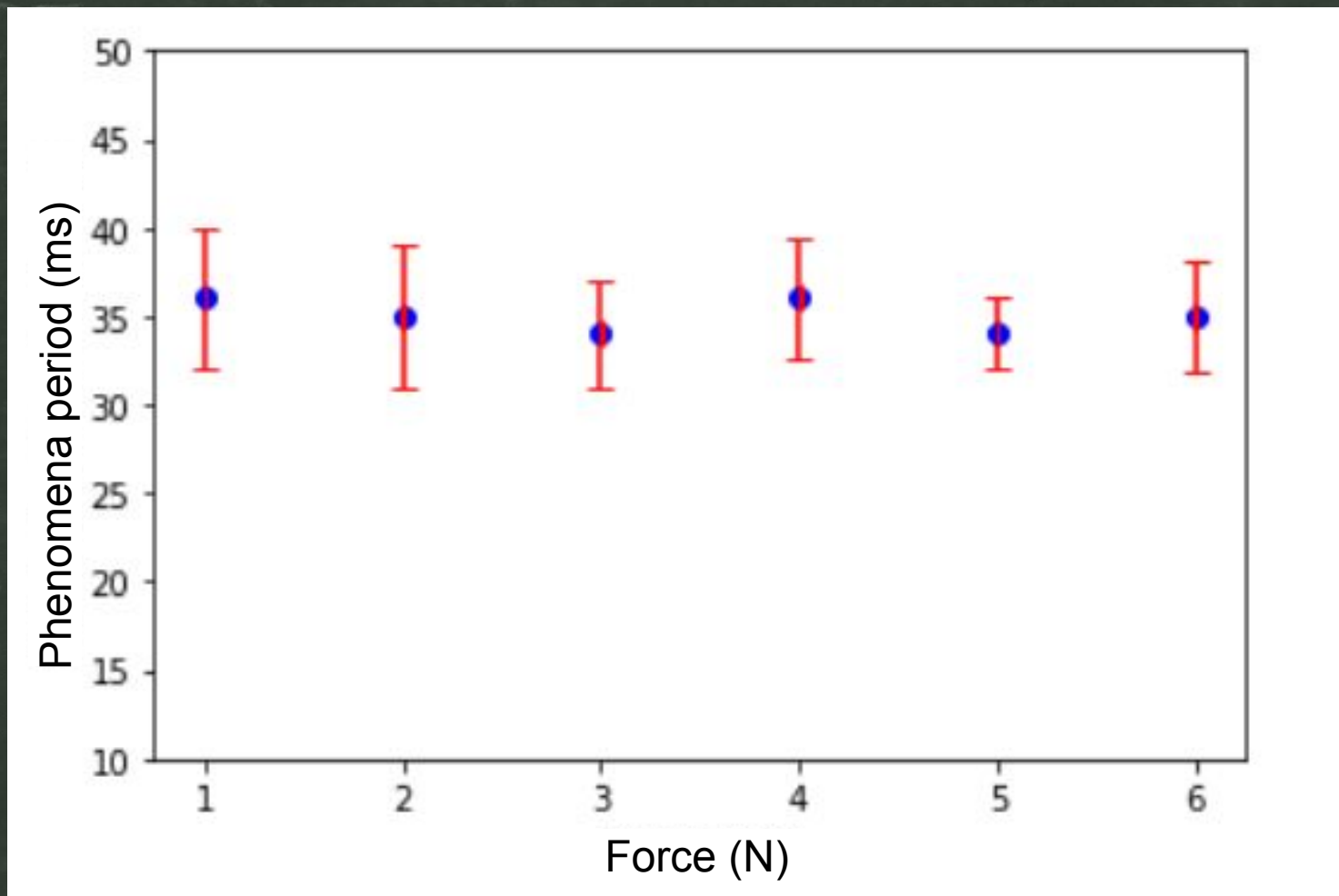
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The period is independent from the speed

III.B – Applied force

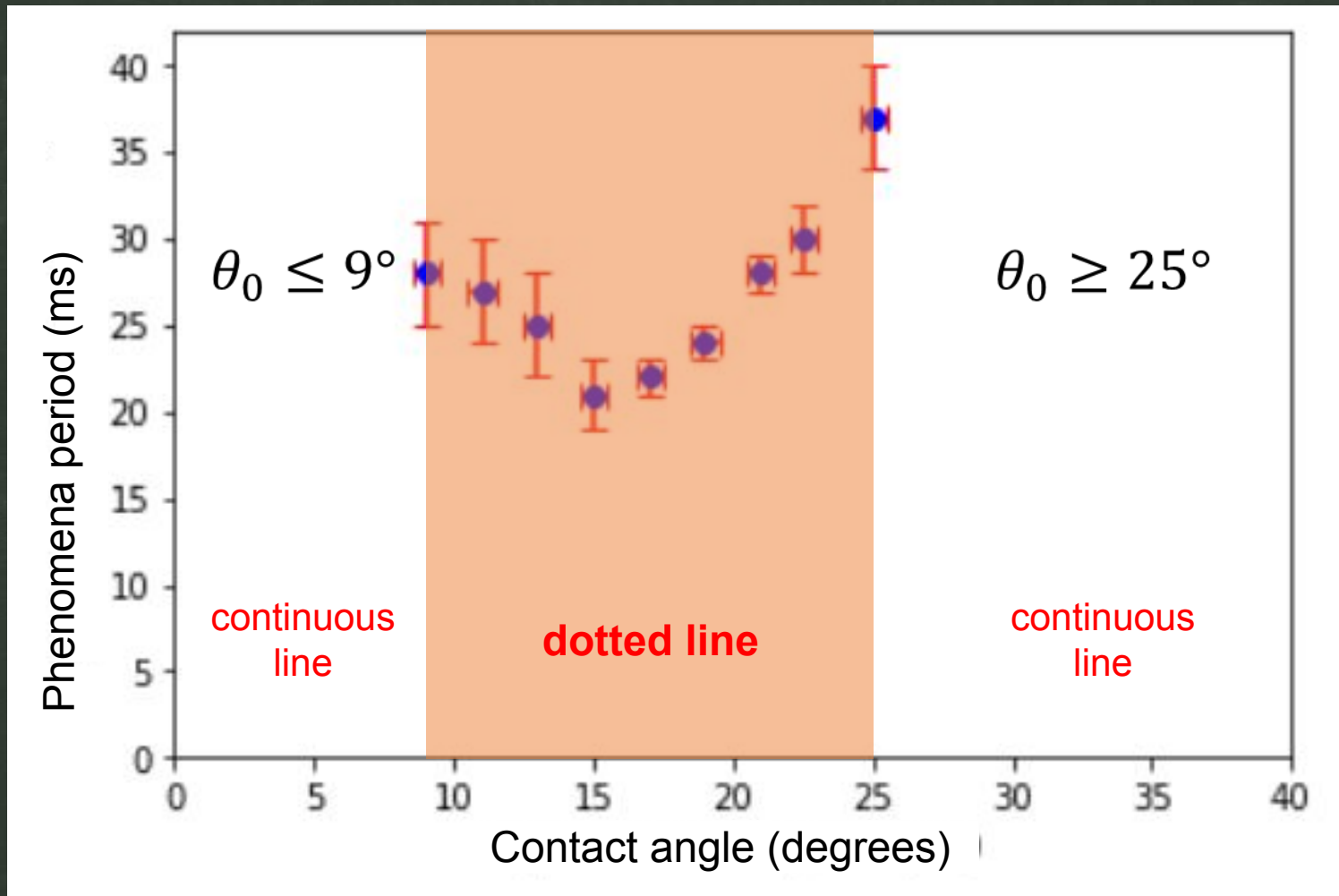
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The period is independent from the applied force

III.C – Contact angle

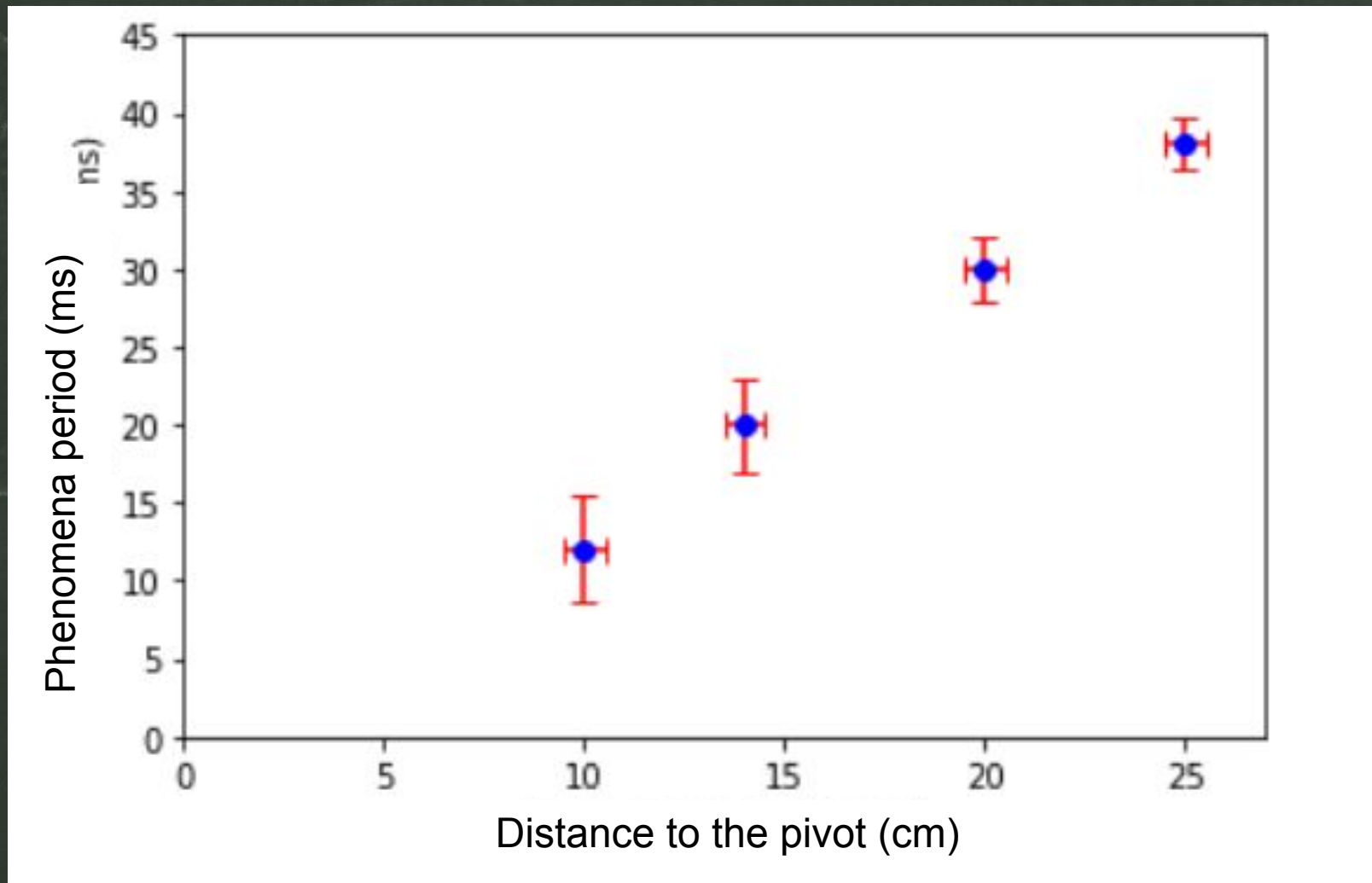
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The period is dependent on the initial angle

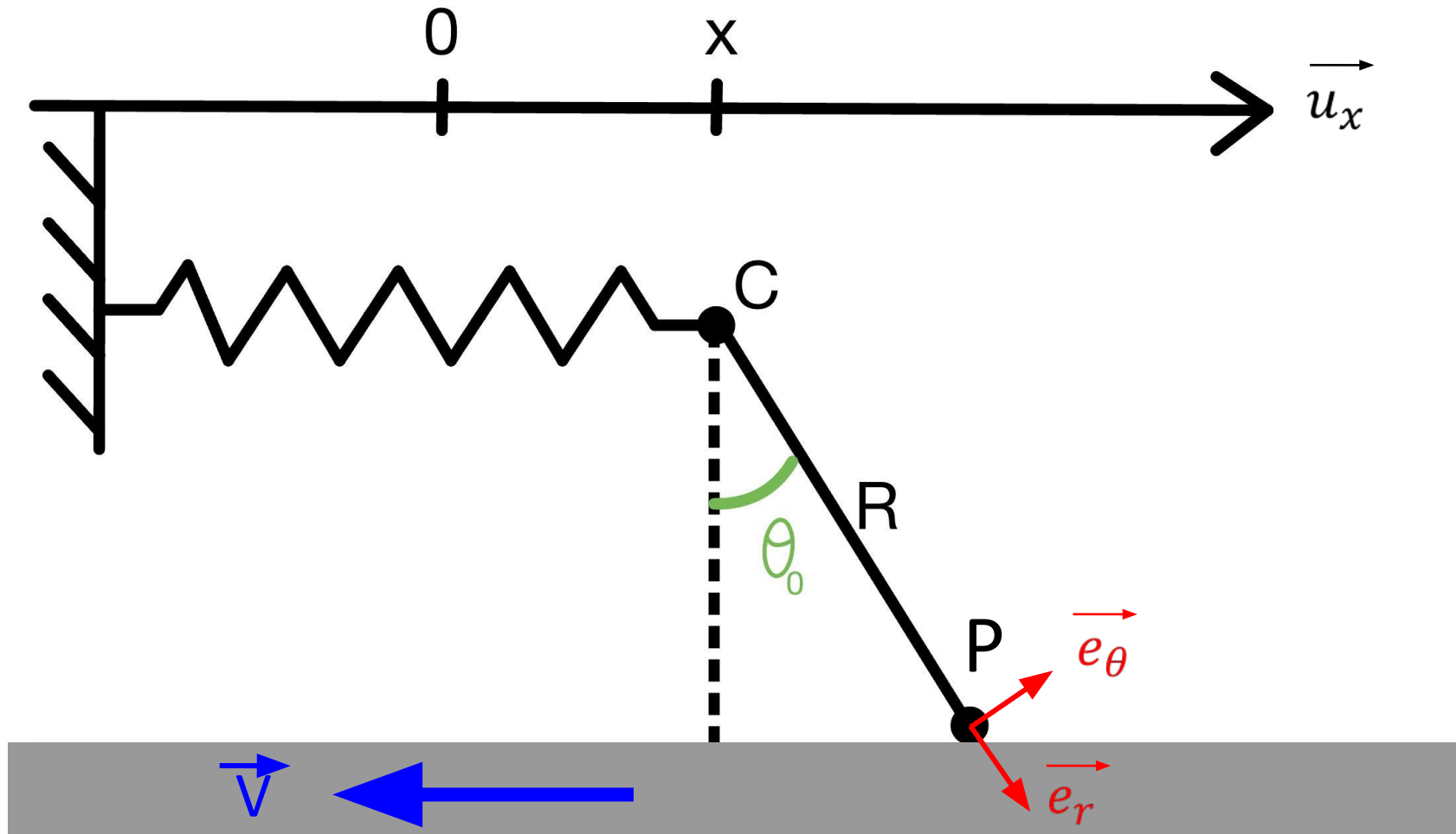
III.D – Distance to pivot

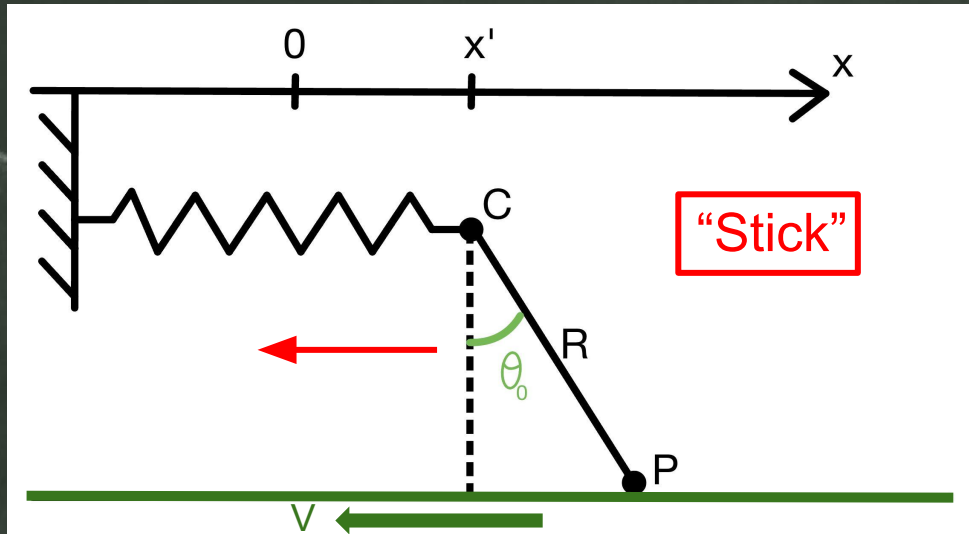
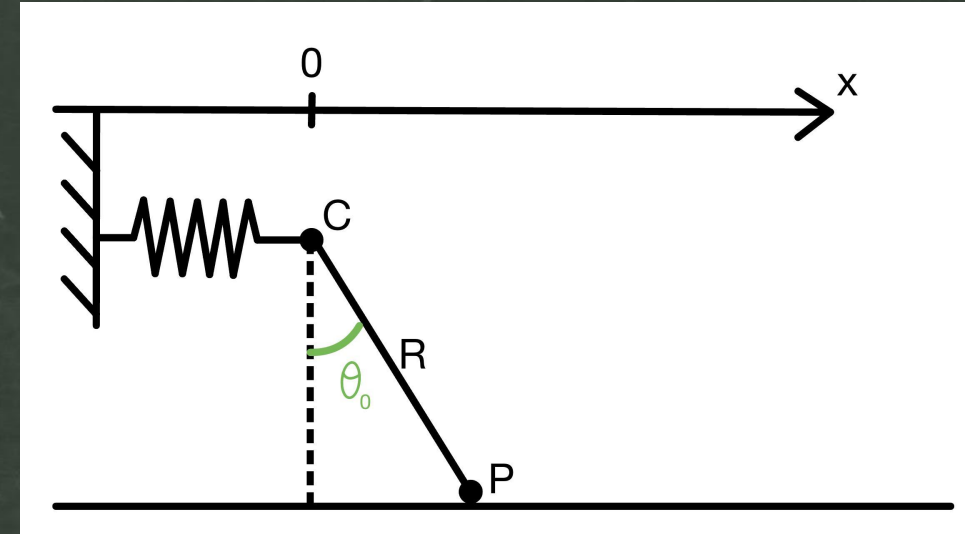
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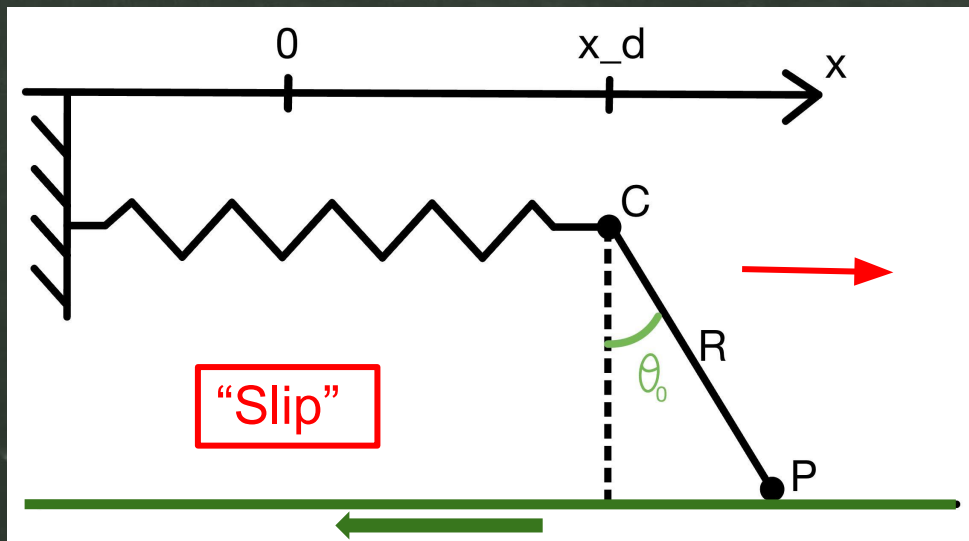
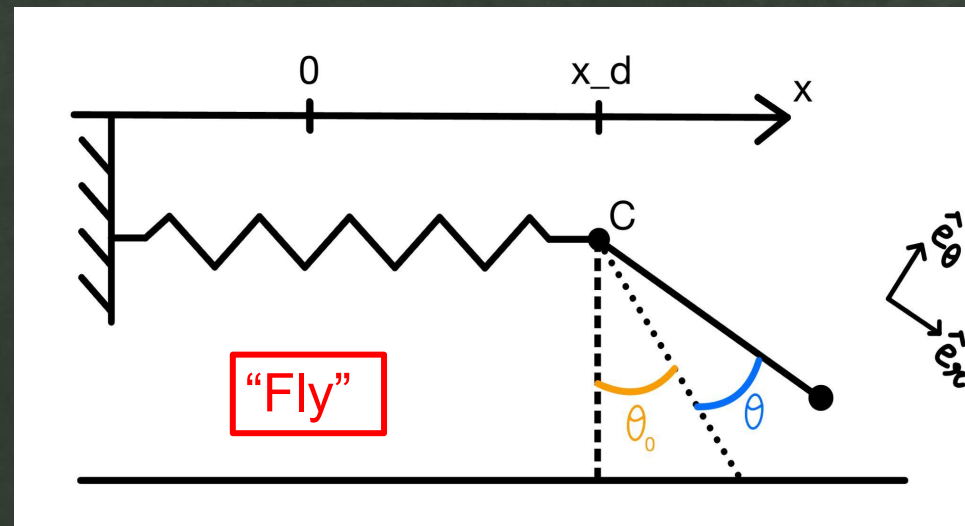
The period is dependent on the distance to the pivot

IV. Theoretical model

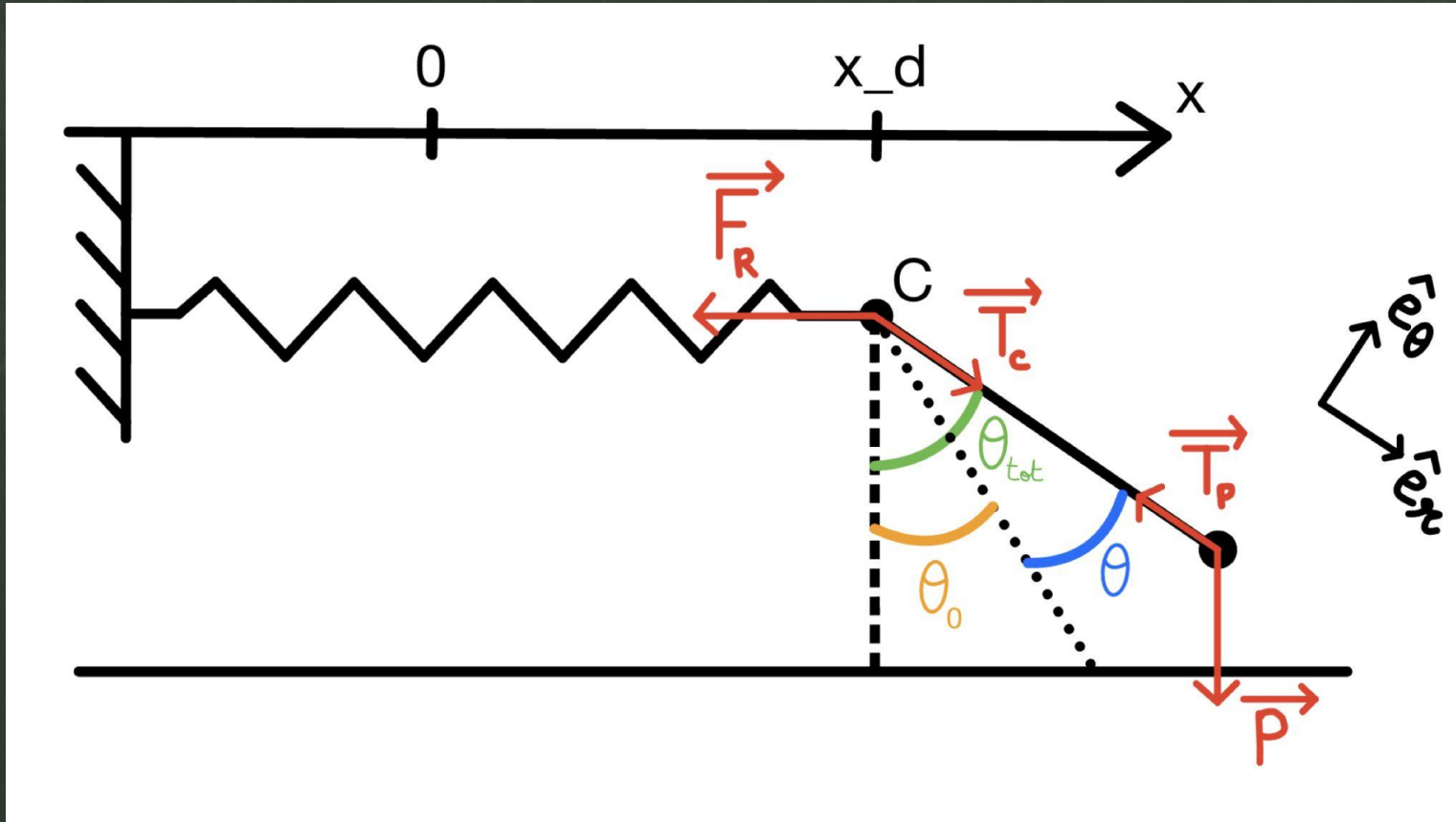


1. Spring compression

Compressed spring

2. Spring extension3. Flying pendulum

Summary of forces



Spring force: F_R

Pendulum tension: T_P, T_C

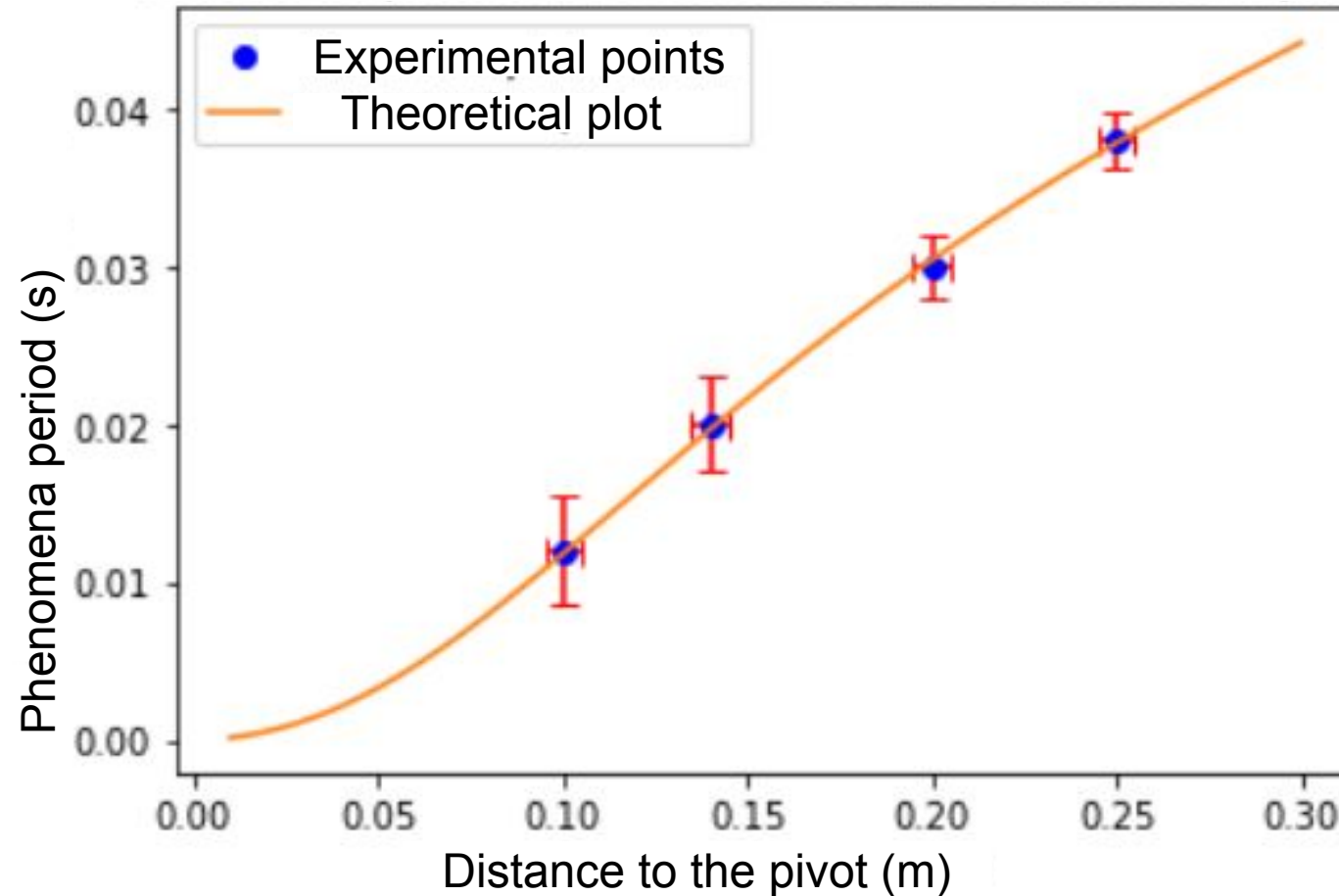
Weight: P

$$T = \frac{2}{\omega_0} \arctan \left(\frac{(1 + \frac{R}{a})\mu_s}{\theta_0} \sqrt{\frac{(1 + \frac{R}{a})(mg + F)}{K}} \right)$$

$$\omega_0 = \sqrt{\frac{mg + F}{mR}}$$

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Phenomena period in function of the distance to the pivot



$K = 43 \text{ N.m}^{-1}$ (fitted)

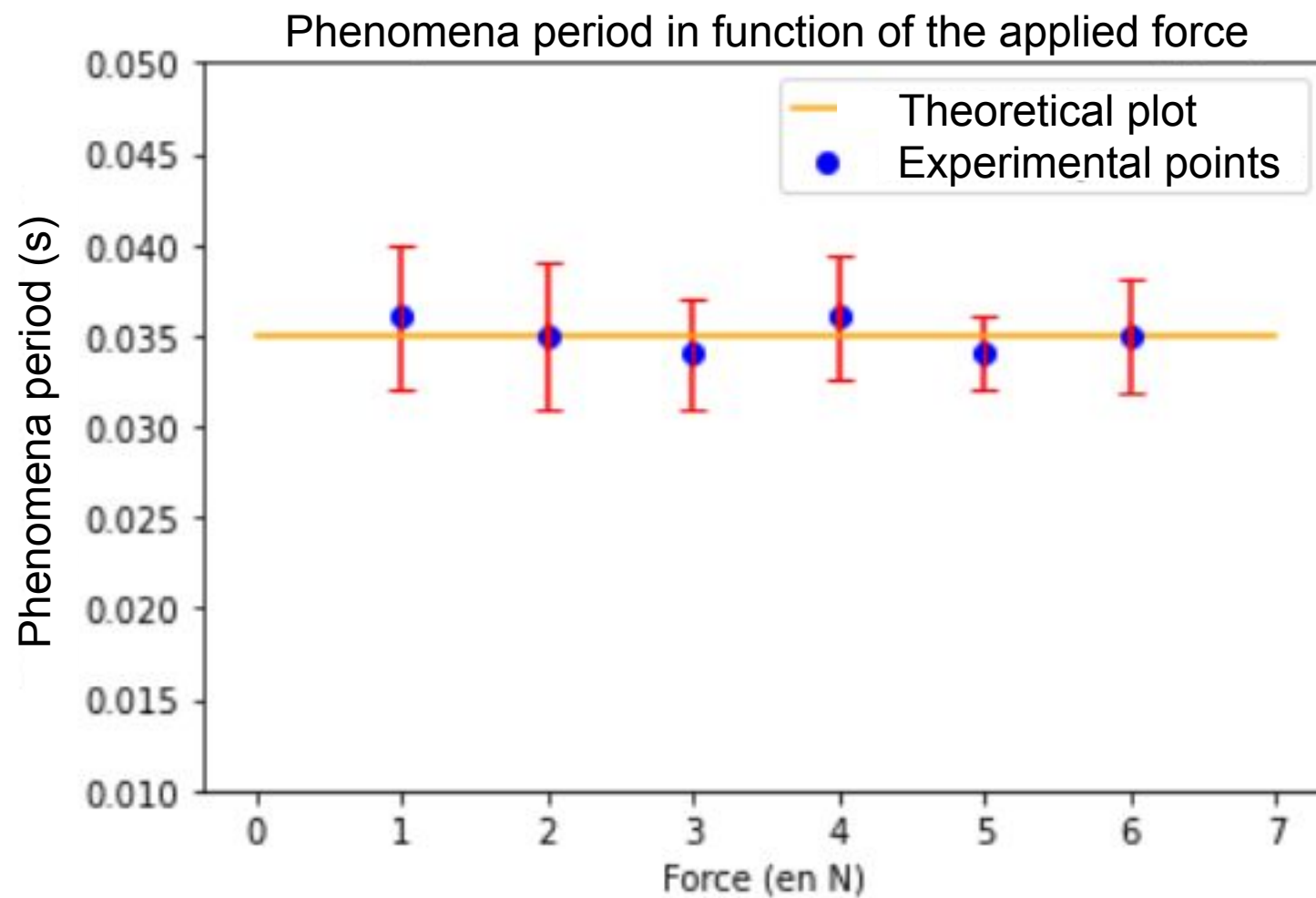
$\theta_0 = 12^\circ$ (fixed)

$\mu_s = 0.53$ (measured)

$F = 4 \text{ N}$ (fixed)

$a = 1 \text{ cm}$ (fixed)

$m = 8 \text{ kg}$ (fitted)

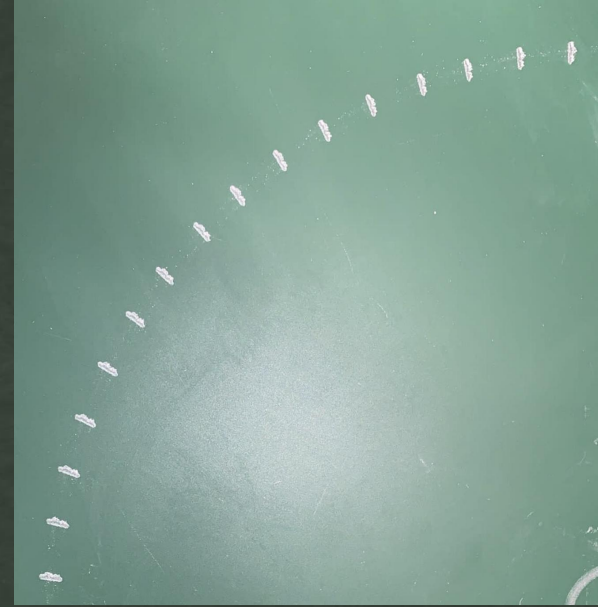
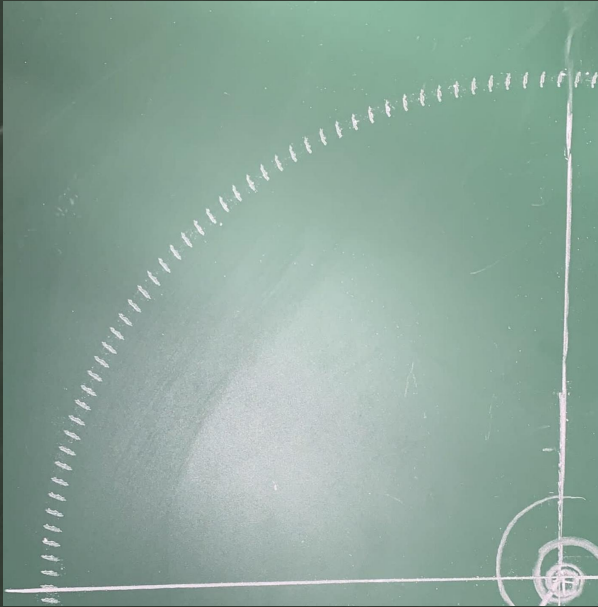


$K = 140 \text{ N.m}^{-1}$ (fitted)

$\theta_0 = 9^\circ$ (fixed)

$R = 18 \text{ cm}$ (fixed)

$m = 7 \text{ kg}$ (fitted)



What parameters from the relative movement between the chalk and the board can be inferred from the resulting trace? Is it possible to infer anything about the dimensions of the chalk? »



The presence of a dotted trace can allow us to narrow the angle of contact to a range of values



If we compare two traces, we can make qualitative comments about the speed and the “length” of the chalk

Appendix

$$\begin{aligned}\theta(t) = & (\theta_0 + \tan(\theta_0))\cos(\Omega_p t) \\ & + \frac{\cos(\theta_0)\omega_r L_{acc}}{R\cos\phi} v \sin\left(\arccos\left(\frac{-\cos\phi}{\cos^2\theta_0\mu_s}\right)\right) \sin(\Omega_p t) \\ & - \tan(\theta_0)\end{aligned}$$

$$\frac{\cos(\phi)}{\cos^2(\theta)\mu_s} < 1$$

$$t_d = \frac{1}{\omega_r} \left(\arccos \left(\frac{-\cos\phi}{\cos^2\theta_0\mu_s} \right) - \phi \right)$$

$$x_d = \frac{(m_1 + m_2)g \tan(\theta_0)}{K}$$